

Seitan à la bourguignonne

With no apologies to boeuf à la bourguignonne, here is my version of the French stew cooked in red wine. This vegetarian version is incredibly rich, slightly sweet, and very satisfying. Serve over rice or noodles.

¼ cup unbleached all-purpose flour [30g]

About ¾ portion cooked Dark Meat Seitan (page 234), cut into bite-size chunks*

3 tablespoons olive oil

1 onion, thinly sliced

1 leek (white and tender green parts), sliced into half-moons

¾ pound cremini or portobello mushrooms (or a combination), thinly sliced [375g]

1 tablespoon fresh thyme, minced

2 teaspoons fresh rosemary, minced

2 carrots, cut into bite-size chunks

3 garlic cloves, thinly sliced

1 teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon freshly ground pepper

2 cups burgundy or other dry red wine [500ml]

3 tablespoons tomato paste

1 bay leaf

1 cup vegetable stock [250ml]

2 tablespoons balsamic vinegar

2 to 3 tablespoons parsley, coarsely chopped

1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice

1. Place the flour in a sealable plastic bag. **Add** the seitan and shake until all the pieces are well coated. Put the coated seitan on a plate and set aside.
2. In a Dutch oven or large soup pot, **heat** 2 tablespoons of the olive oil over medium-high heat. Fry the seitan in batches without crowding until browned on all sides. Use tongs to turn the pieces. You may have to add more oil as you go along. Remove the seitan and set aside.
3. **Heat** another 1½ tablespoons oil in the same pot. Add the onion and leek and cook over medium heat until very soft and lightly browned, 5 to 7 minutes. Add the

*You may substitute 8 ounces [250g] of store-bought seitan.

mushrooms, thyme, and rosemary and cook, stirring often, until the mushrooms are tender, about 3 minutes. Add the carrots and garlic and cook for another minute. Season with the salt and pepper.

4. Add the wine and bring to a boil. **Cook** for 10 minutes, stirring frequently. Stir in the tomato paste. Add the seitan and the bay leaf. Reduce the heat to a simmer, cover with the lid ajar, and cook for 45 minutes.
5. Stir in the stock and vinegar. Continue to **simmer** uncovered for about 15 minutes longer, stirring often, until the stew is thickened to your liking. Stir in the parsley and lemon juice and season with additional salt and pepper to taste.

SERVES 4 TO 6

